

## 2026 Midterm Elections Candidate Questionnaire on HIV/AIDS Issues

AIDS Foundation Chicago (AFC)

Candidate First Name: Kevin

Candidate Last Name: Morrison

State Where Candidate is Running: Illinois

Congressional Chamber: U.S. House of Representatives

Congressional District: IL-08

Party Affiliation (optional): Democrat

### Candidate Questions & Responses

#### 1. Medicaid Cuts Under H.R. 1

I strongly oppose any legislation that increases the number of uninsured Americans—especially when nearly 42% of people living with HIV in Illinois rely on Medicaid for coverage. Health care is a human right. I would work to reverse harmful Medicaid cuts and expand federal support for Medicaid, including strengthening enhanced federal matching rates for states like Illinois. I support protecting the Affordable Care Act, expanding eligibility, closing coverage gaps, and ensuring continuous coverage protections. I would also advocate for targeted federal stabilization funds for safety-net hospitals and Ryan White providers that serve communities most impacted by HIV. Protecting Medicaid is both morally right and fiscally responsible.

#### 2. Domestic HIV Program Funding Cuts

Yes. I unequivocally commit to opposing cuts to domestic HIV programs and to supporting increased federal investment in prevention, treatment, research, and housing. Eliminating CDC HIV Prevention programs and slashing the Ryan White Program would reverse decades of progress. I support fully funding the Ending the HIV Epidemic Initiative, protecting the Minority AIDS Initiative, and strengthening the Ryan White Program's core medical and supportive services. To end the epidemic, we must scale up testing, expand access to PrEP and long-acting injectable prevention, reduce stigma, and invest in culturally competent community-based providers.

### **3. Housing & Homelessness Policies**

Housing is health care. Stable housing dramatically improves adherence to HIV treatment and reduces transmission. I support reinstating and strengthening Housing First policies, protecting HIV-dedicated housing units, and expanding rental assistance for people living with HIV. I will advocate for increased funding for HOPWA and the Continuum of Care program, and oppose policy changes that reduce permanent supportive housing.

### **4. HOPWA Program**

Yes. HOPWA is essential to ensuring that people living with HIV can access stable housing. I will defend and increase HOPWA funding, oppose harmful regulatory rollbacks, and push for modernization to reflect current housing costs. Housing stability saves lives and reduces long-term health care costs.

### **5. PrEP Access & National Program**

Yes. I support establishing and funding a national PrEP program to eliminate cost barriers for uninsured and underinsured individuals. Long-acting injectable PrEP represents a breakthrough in prevention, but only if it is accessible. We must address racial disparities in PrEP uptake by investing in culturally competent outreach, expanding Medicaid coverage, and removing prior authorization barriers.

### **6. Minority AIDS Initiative & Health Equity**

Yes. The Minority AIDS Initiative is critical to addressing racial disparities in HIV outcomes. I will fight to increase funding and ensure resources flow directly to community-led organizations serving disproportionately impacted communities. We must expand culturally competent care and address social determinants of health including housing and income stability.

### **7. NIH & HIV Research Funding**

Yes. NIH-funded research has transformed HIV care and prevention. Cutting NIH funding would stall progress toward new prevention tools and potential cures. I support fully funding HIV/AIDS research and restoring eliminated research networks.

### **8. Harm Reduction & Overdose Prevention**

Yes. Harm reduction saves lives. I support evidence-based approaches including syringe service programs, overdose prevention centers, medication-assisted treatment, and

integrated HIV prevention services. Federal policy should empower states to adopt life-saving public health strategies.

#### **9. Protections for Transgender Individuals**

Yes. I support passage of the Equality Act and broader federal protections to ensure transgender and gender-diverse individuals are protected from discrimination in health care, housing, and employment. Policies that marginalize transgender people undermine our ability to end the HIV epidemic. As the first openly gay County Commissioner in Cook County history, I understand the importance of representation, standing firmly for LGBTQ+ rights, and that is why I made gender identity a protected class for 5.2 million people..

#### **10. Congressional HIV/AIDS Caucus**

Yes. I will join the Congressional HIV/AIDS Caucus in my first year in office and actively work to elevate the voices of people living with HIV. Policy must be informed by lived experience and community partnership.